the chief link between the two *being always found* in the person of Dr. Saif-ud-din Kitchlew'.[19]

Against this background, one should not forget that the local Congress Party Committee was founded in Amritsar only two years earlier in October 1917, expressly 'with the object of uniting Hindus and Musalmans in political action', so that it was not too difficult to see how '[t]he fact that the next meeting of the All India Congress [that] was to be held in Amritsar' thereafter became 'undoubtedly a contributory cause' to the agitation in 1919.[20] Remarkably, there was still no risk of impending mob violence. What was threatened was civil disobedience. It was for this reason that the government of the day had to find more insidious ways of dealing with what it saw as a threat to its authority. All along there was no risk of violence nor was any one threatened. What it was having to deal with was passive resistance. For the government, '[t]he situation had however begun to take a threatening aspect. It was not that any immediate violence was apprehended. On the contrary the policy of the brains behind the movement appeared to be directed in the opposite direction. It seemed their intention [was] to avoid any collision with authority which would justify armed intervention and to train the crowd with a view to some collective form of passive disobedience to authority . . .'.[21]

To their horror, the Muslims and Hindus of Punjab did come together when, '[o]n the evening of April 9th the festival of Ram Naumi was observed. An important feature of this was the fact that although it is a purely Hindu festival it was celebrated by Muhammadans and Hindus alike. Water was provided by Muhammadans and drunk from their hands by Hindus, although, it is true, in silver vessels. And as the procession passed, the cries raised were, in place of those giving honour to the Hindu deities, the political shouts of "*Hindu Musalman Ki Jai*"'.[22] What is surprising but fully acknowledged by the authorities is that '[a]t the same time there was little sign of active hostility to Government and none of the hostility to Europeans as such. The Deputy Commissioner by accident was caught in the crowd and witnessed the procession unguarded from the verandah of the Allahabad Bank'.[23] There was accordingly no threat to public security or a